

# LYS Workflow Knowledge Base

A plain-language reference for how the platform's key workflows behave — what users should expect, and what admins/developers should expect behind the scenes. Organized by area. Keep this document updated as workflows change; the PDF is regenerated from this file with ``npx tsx scripts/generate-workflow-kb-pdf.ts``.

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## 1. Billing

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### 1.1 Paying by card (Stripe)

**Who it's for:** Individual educators and schools upgrading to Pro or Campus.

**What the user experiences:**

- On the Pricing page, they click the upgrade button for Pro or Campus.
- A checkout dialog opens; they pick "Credit / Debit Card" and authorize billing.
- They are sent to Stripe's secure checkout page to enter card details.
- On success, they are returned to the app and the plan is active immediately — no waiting, no manual steps.
- Stripe emails them a receipt automatically.

**What admins/devs should expect:**

- Nothing manual. Stripe notifies the server (webhook) and the account upgrades automatically.
- The payment appears in the Stripe dashboard alongside all other card payments (refunds, receipts, and reporting live there).
- If a payment fails, the plan simply does not activate — there is no partial state to clean up.

### 1.2 Paying by purchase order (PO)

**Who it's for:** Schools and districts that pay through an institutional purchasing process (Pro or Campus tiers).

**What the user experiences:**

- In the checkout dialog they pick "Purchase Order" and fill in: PO number, organization name, contact name, contact email, and optional notes.
- The form checks the entries before submitting (bad or missing fields show a clear red message under the field).
- On success, their account is provisioned immediately and marked "PO pending" — they can start using the plan right away while the invoice is processed.

**What admins/devs should expect:**

- A notification email goes to the central sales inbox: `info@ladderingyoursuccess.com` (this can be overridden with the `PO_NOTIFY_EMAIL` or `PLATFORM_OWNER_EMAIL` setting).
- The PO appears in the admin area under Billing > Purchase Orders.
- An admin must manually mark the PO as paid once the invoice clears. Until then the account stays in the "PO pending" state.

### 1.3 Paying from a bank account (ACH Direct Debit)

**Current status:** live — real payments through Stripe.

### What the user experiences:

- In the checkout dialog they pick "Bank Account (ACH)", check the bank-debit authorization box, and click "Pay from Bank Account".
- They are redirected to Stripe's secure checkout, where they connect their US bank account (instant verification with most banks) and authorize the payment.
- Back in the app, their plan is activated right away with a "bank payment processing" notice. The debit itself clears in about 4 business days.

### What admins/devs should expect:

- On checkout completion the account is provisioned with subscription status "payment\_pending" (same trust model as PO pending).
- A Stripe webhook finalizes it: if the debit succeeds the status flips to active; if it fails (insufficient funds, closed account) the account reverts to the free tier automatically. Both outcomes are written to the audit log.
- One-time setup: ACH Direct Debit must be enabled in the Stripe dashboard (Settings > Payment methods), otherwise Stripe checkout will reject the session.

## 1.4 Enterprise (districts, charter networks, multi-site orgs)

**Who it's for:** ISDs, charter management organizations, and any multi-campus network.

### What the user experiences:

- The Pricing page shows an enterprise cost estimator (base price + per-seat + per-campus) so they can see an estimate before talking to anyone.
- Clicking "Contact Sales" (on the enterprise tier card or at the bottom of the page) opens an email to [info@ladderingyoursuccess.com](mailto:info@ladderingyoursuccess.com).
- From there, pricing and payment are worked out directly with the LYS team — typically ending in a purchase order or invoice rather than self-serve checkout.

### What admins/devs should expect:

- Enterprise inquiries arrive as plain email at [info@ladderingyoursuccess.com](mailto:info@ladderingyoursuccess.com) — there is no in-app queue for them.
- If the deal closes via purchase order, the standard PO workflow above applies (provision, PO-pending, mark paid).

## 1.5 Billing quick-reference table

| Method             | Plan activates                               | Admin action needed                               | Where money is tracked            |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Card (Stripe)      | Instantly                                    | None                                              | Stripe dashboard                  |
| Purchase order     | Instantly (PO pending)                       | Mark paid when invoice clears                     | Admin > Billing > Purchase Orders |
| Bank account (ACH) | Instantly (payment pending ~4 business days) | None — webhook activates or reverts automatically | Stripe dashboard                  |
| Enterprise         | After deal closes                            | Handle inquiry by email; then PO flow             | Email + PO flow                   |